



Noctua NH-L9x65

This thing is small. Really small...

Features 88
Build Quality 90
Performance 60
Value for money 55

Specifications

CPU Support: Intel Socket LGA 2011-0/2011-3/1156/1155/1150 AMD Socket FM1/FM2/ FM2+/AM3+/AM3/AM2+/AM2; **Dimensions:** 65(H) x 95(D) x 95(W) mm; **Weight:** 413 grams; **Base:** Copper (Nickel plated); **Fan Speed:** 2500 RPM (+/-10%); **Warranty:** 6 years

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We tested two low profile CPU coolers – the Noctua NH-D9L and Noctua NH-U9S just last month and were quite

impressed with them. This time around, we have another much smaller (read 65mm) offering from Noctua that aims to provide the perfect fit on a Mini-ITX board. It doesn't obstruct RAM or PCIe slots on the board thus making it 100% compatible for a Mini-ITX based system. We also saw that the area around the socket after installing the cooler didn't get too cramped which you know is really helpful if you've ever worked on a Mini-ITX build. Apart from its small dimensions, the NH-L9x65 has a plain squarish look to it but it's apparent that Noctua were gunning for the



Price
₹3,800

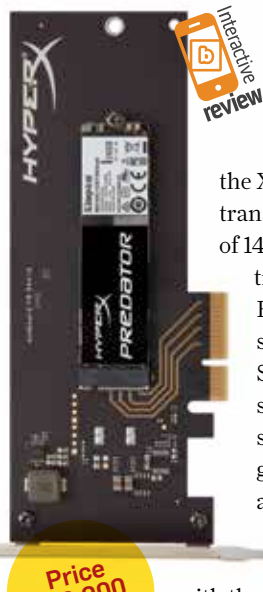
shortest heat-sink height possible which wouldn't hamper performance and they've hit the bull's eye with that. Speaking of performance, the NH-L9x65 managed to keep the 3770K at 35°C when idle and the load temperature never crossed 67°C. Although the load temperatures are on the higher side, they're alright for a cooler this size and it fares much better than the Intel stock cooler. The NH-L9x65 uses the Noctua NF-A9x14 fan that runs almost silent but is slightly audible at max fan speed. With an impeccable build quality, a long list of accessories that include the popular Noctua NT-H1 thermal paste among other useful things, the NH-L9x65 is a dependable low-profile cooler to go for.

Siddhant Sharma

Kingston HyperX Predator 480GB SSD

So long SATA, PCIe here we come

There aren't many M.2 SSDs marketed for desktop PCs. Samsung did come out with the XP941 last year and the benchmark figures were off the charts. The Kingston HyperX Predator is a similar device but with a few benchmarks ranking it higher than the competitor from Samsung. It uses a PCIe Gen 2.0 interface and requires four PCIe lanes. The adapter looks quite good with a matte black PCB solder mask that has now become staple in the motherboard industry so there's no way it's going to look out of place. The big HyperX branding on the top is also a nice touch. Moreover, in case you do feel like using an M.2 drive that isn't 80mm long in this adapter then it does have mounting holes for 42mm, 60mm and 110mm cards provided they are M-keyed. This particular SKU even came with a low height adapter. The



Price
₹48,000
(Estimated)



eight NAND chips used on the Predator are Toshiba A19 MLC NAND, each being of 64 GB.

Performance wise, the Predator registers ahead of the XP941 when it comes to IOPS and transfer rates. With read/write speeds of 1400MB/s and 1000MB/s respectively, it does seem really promising. However, 4K and 4KQD32 write speeds are lower than what most SATA SSDs come with. The Samsung 850 Pro produced a 4K write speed of 167.6MB/s and the Predator gave us 113.5MB/s. 4K read speeds are in tandem with SATA SSDs, so if you look at the big picture, you are indeed moving up with the Predator and it comes to you for an estimated price tag of ₹48,000.

Mithun Mobandas



Performance 90
Build 70
Value for Money 55

Specifications

SHPM2280P2H/480G
Form factor: M.2 2280 with PCIe; **Cost/GB:** '100; **Dimensions:** 80x22x3.5 mm; **Controller:** Marvell 88SS9293; Toshiba MLC NAND; **Warranty:** 3 years

Contact

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